Take Up *His Cross*

Whoever loses his life for My sake will find it.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 16:21-28 in the LSB | 21:32 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The SHOCKING Words of Jesus No One Wanted To Hear. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 16:21-28. From that time Jesus begins to show His disciples that He must go to Jerusalem, suffer many things, be killed, and be raised on the third day. Peter takes Him aside and rebukes Him; Jesus answers, 'Get behind Me, Satan!' Then He teaches that anyone who wants to come after Him must deny himself, take up his cross and follow Him, for the Son of Man will come and repay each one according to his deeds.
- This is the first time Jesus openly discusses His death and resurrection, hence Peter's strong reaction. The last place named is Caesarea Philippi (16:13), so they are probably still there; the video believes the transfiguration that follows took place on Mount Hermon. The leaders of 16:21 together stand for the Sanhedrin.
- A few verses after being called Petros, Peter is a skandalon, a stumbling block. Jesus uses the same command He used to Satan in 4:10. Human thinking can unknowingly align with satanic purposes.
- Mark says Jesus called the crowd as well (Mark 8:34). Taking up the cross is a continuing act (Luke 9:23, 'daily'). Two treasures are set side by side (6:19-21; 10:38-39), and the promise to repay recalls Psalm 62:12 and Proverbs 24:12, a comfort to those who give up the world's riches.

> *"Fans of Jesus seek comfort over a cross. Followers of Jesus seek the cross over comfort.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"He was Petros. Now he's skandalon.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: fans of Jesus seek comfort over a cross; followers of Jesus seek the cross over comfort. The crowds of John 6 eventually left; followers remain.



Take up his cross and follow Me

El Greco, Christ Carrying the Cross, 1590-1595. Google Art Project via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Read the Psalm around the verse

When Jesus' words echo the Old Testament, the teacher zooms out to the whole passage. Psalm 62 turns 'He will repay' from a threat into a comfort for those who will not trust in riches.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 16:21-28 and turns to Matthew 4, 6 and 10, Mark 8, Luke 9, Psalm 62, Proverbs 24 and John 6. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 16:21-28
Read in full: the passion prediction, Peter's rebuke, and the cost of following.

Matthew 4:10
'Go, Satan!' The same command.

Mark 8:31-9:1
Mark's account; Jesus summons the crowd.

Luke 9:22-27
Luke adds 'daily.'

Matthew 6:19-21
Treasures on earth and in heaven.

Matthew 10:38-39
The cross said before.

Psalms 62:9-12
Do not set your heart on riches; You repay.

Proverbs 24:12
He will render to man according to his work.

John 6:26-27
The crowds sought loaves.

John 6:66-68
Many went away.

Matthew 17:1-13
Coming next: the transfiguration.

Key verses in the LSB

“From that time Jesus began to show His disciples that He must go to Jerusalem, and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised up on the third day.”
Matthew 16:21 (LSB)

“Then Jesus said to His disciples, “If anyone wishes to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross and follow Me.”
Matthew 16:24 (LSB)

“For what will it profit a man if he gains the whole world and forfeits his soul? Or what will a man give in exchange for his soul?”
Matthew 16:26 (LSB)

Get behind Me, Satan

The first plain prediction, Peter's outburst, and a rock that trips.

MATTHEW 16:21

From that time

🗓️ MATTHEW 16:21 (LSB)

FIRST PLAINLY

“From that time Jesus began to show His disciples that He must go to Jerusalem, and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised up on the third day.”

FROM THE VIDEO This is the first time Jesus openly discusses His death and resurrection with His disciples. Jesus has spent much time outside Judea and Jerusalem, and He knows that when He returns the religious leaders will kill Him.

FROM THE VIDEO Elders, chief priests and scribes together are an all-encompassing term for the Jewish leaders, the Sanhedrin, the supreme legislative body of the Jewish people.

BACKGROUND He had hinted before: the bridegroom 'taken away' (9:15) and the sign of Jonah (12:40). Matthew 9:15 Matthew 12:40

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem ◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin ◆ Factbook: Scribe ◆ Factbook: Priest

MATTHEW 16:22

God forbid it, Lord!

✋ MATTHEW 16:22 (LSB)

OUTBURST

“And Peter took Him aside and began to rebuke Him, saying, “God forbid it, Lord! This shall never happen to You.””

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples seem to have missed the part about being raised. Peter's immediate emotional outburst suggests they heard only suffering and death and stopped listening.

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

MATTHEW 16:18, 23

From Petros to skandalon

JESUS · MATTHEW 16:18

“And I also say to you that you are Peter, and upon this rock I will build My church; and the gates of Hades will not overpower it.”

JESUS · MATTHEW 16:23

“But He turned and said to Peter, “Get behind Me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to Me; for you are not setting your mind on God’s interests, but man’s.””

FROM THE VIDEO In just a few verses Peter goes from Petros, a rock to build on, to skandalon, another kind of rock: a stone to trip over.

FROM THE VIDEO This is not long after Jesus commended him for insight that came from God. 'We should all chew on that one.'

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Satan

MATTHEW 4:10; 16:23

The same command to Satan

IN THE WILDERNESS · MATTHEW 4:10

“Then Jesus *said to him, “Go, Satan! For it is written, ‘You shall worship the Lord your God, and serve Him only.’””

TO PETER · MATTHEW 16:23

“But He turned and said to Peter, “Get behind Me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to Me; for you are not setting your mind on God’s interests, but man’s.””

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus uses the same verb He used to command Satan to be gone. Avoiding the cross is antithetical to God's plan, direct opposition to God.

FROM THE VIDEO Ask Peter whether he wanted to serve Satan's purposes and he would say, 'Absolutely not.' Yet human thinking can unknowingly align with satanic purposes.

◆ Factbook: Temptation of Jesus ◆ Factbook: Satan



Get behind Me, Satan!

James Tissot, Get Thee Behind Me Satan, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“He was Petros. Now he's skandalon.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Deny yourself and take up your cross

An open call, a daily cross, and two treasures.

MARK 8:34

He called the crowd too

MARK 8:34 (LSB)

OPEN CALL

“And He summoned the crowd with His disciples, and said to them, “If anyone wishes to come after Me, he must deny himself, and take up his cross and follow Me.”

FROM THE VIDEO Mark shows the disciples were not the only ones listening. The invitation is open to anyone with ears to hear.

FROM THE VIDEO It is unclear where the crowd came from: perhaps Bethsaida, where Jesus healed a blind man (Mark 8:22-26), or nearer the Decapolis and the four thousand. Mark 8:22-26

◆ Factbook: Bethsaida ◆ Factbook: Decapolis



MATTHEW 16:24; LUKE 9:23

Take up your cross, daily

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 16:24

"Then Jesus said to His disciples, "If anyone wishes to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross and follow Me."

LUKE · LUKE 9:23

"And He was saying to them all, "If anyone wishes to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily and follow Me."

FROM THE VIDEO Carrying one's cross is not a one-time event but a continuing act of the disciple. Luke captures this more obviously with 'daily.'

FROM THE VIDEO To deny oneself means to renounce one's own desires, status and self-interest, to seek Jesus' ways over one's own comfort.

◆ Factbook: Disciples



MATTHEW 16:25-26; 6:19-21

Two treasures

JESUS · MATTHEW 16:26

"For what will it profit a man if he gains the whole world and forfeits his soul? Or what will a man give in exchange for his soul?"

JESUS · MATTHEW 6:20-21

"But store up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust destroys, and where thieves do not break in or steal; for where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."

FROM THE VIDEO Pursuing the world's treasure costs your soul and disappears with the world; pursuing God's treasure preserves your soul, with heavenly and everlasting rewards.

FROM THE VIDEO This is a rehash of Matthew 6:19-21, and Jesus has said it before: 'And he who does not take his cross and follow after Me is not worthy of Me' (Matthew 10:38). Matthew 10:38

◆ Factbook: Mammon



THE LESSON

Fans and followers

FROM THE VIDEO Fans of Jesus seek comfort over a cross. Followers of Jesus seek the cross over comfort. Fans refuse to deny self; followers want to be like their rabbi and are fully committed to the adventure of walking after Him.

FROM THE VIDEO Fans may say amen loudly, admire His miracles and even study Him. Followers do all that, but they also sacrifice and suffer, because Jesus' destiny is their destiny.

◆ Factbook: Rabbi

> *“Fans of Jesus seek comfort over a cross. Followers of Jesus seek the cross over comfort.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

He will repay each one

Psalm 62, a promise of comfort, and why the crowds left.



MATTHEW 16:27; PSALM 62:12

He will repay each one

JESUS · MATTHEW 16:27

“For the Son of Man is going to come in the glory of His Father with His angels, and will then repay each one according to his deeds.”

DAVID · PSALMS 62:12

“And that to You, O Lord, belongs lovingkindness, / For You repay a man according to his work.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus' promise is connected to Psalm 62:12, and Proverbs 24:12 restates it: 'And will not He render to man according to his work?' **Proverbs 24:12**

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Judgment ◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Book of Proverbs



PSALM 62:10

Do not set your heart on riches

PSALMS 62:10 (LSB) CONTEXT

“Do not trust in oppression / And do not put vain hope in robbery; / If riches increase, do not set your heart upon them.”

FROM THE VIDEO In Psalm 62 David is fed up with the corruption and deception of mankind. The world's wealth is corrupt and fleeting; God's reward is eternal life and a refuge.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus tracks David's argument when He asks what it profits a man to gain the whole world (16:26).

◆ Factbook: David



COMFORT, NOT ONLY THREAT

A promise to those who give up comfort

FROM THE VIDEO We often hear 'He will repay' as a scary threat to evildoers. That is entailed, the video says, but here it is a comfort: to those who choose the cross over comfort, Jesus promises to repay them.

BACKGROUND Chrysostom read it the same way: after alarming them, 'He comforts them also by His good things.'

JOHN 6:26-27, 66

Why the crowds left

JESUS · JOHN 6:26

"Jesus answered them and said, "Truly, truly, I say to you, you seek Me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves and were filled."

JOHN · JOHN 6:66

"As a result of this many of His disciples went away and were not walking with Him anymore."

FROM THE VIDEO We know why the crowds came: miracles and food. Shortly afterward many left because He told them things they did not want to hear.

FROM THE VIDEO Fans follow self, and the self refuses anything that challenges its own sovereignty and comfort.

◆ Factbook: Jesus feeds the 5,000

> *"It is possible for human thinking to unknowingly align with satanic purposes.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in 16:21-28

What the video says, then a short background note.

Simon Peter

VIDEO Rebukes Jesus and is called Satan and a stumbling block.

BACKGROUND Later Peter writes that Christ suffered, 'leaving you an example' (1 Peter 2:21).

1 Peter 2:21 ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

Elders, chief priests and scribes

VIDEO Together, the whole leadership, the Sanhedrin.

BACKGROUND They will meet at Caiaphas' house to plot His death (26:3-4).

Matthew 26:3-4 ◆ Sanhedrin ◆ Priest ◆ Scribe

The crowd

VIDEO Called with the disciples to hear the cost (Mark 8:34); fans who will eventually leave.

BACKGROUND John 6 records many disciples turning back.

John 6:66 ◆ Disciples

David

VIDEO In Psalm 62, fed up with corruption, he trusts God who repays.

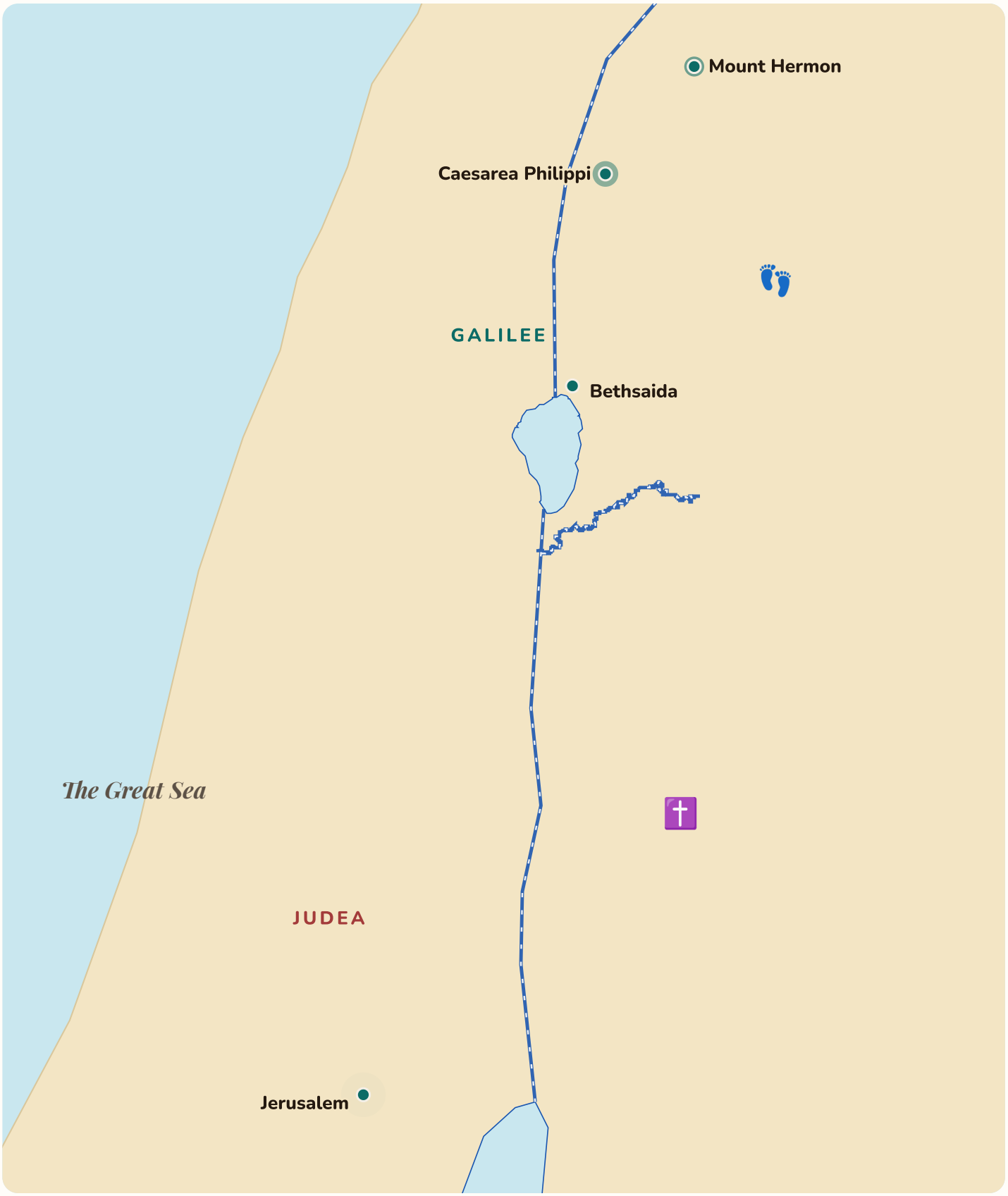
BACKGROUND Psalm 62 is headed 'A Psalm of David.'

Psalms 62:1 ◆ David ◆ Book of Psalms

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

From Caesarea Philippi to Jerusalem

Gold pins are background; the pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names.



● Named in the video ● Background

Positions from known sites; Hermon's summit is shown. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Caesarea Philippi VIDEO

The last place named (16:13); probably where this teaching happens.

◆ Factbook: Philip the tetrarch (Herod Philip II)

◆ Factbook: Caesarea Philippi

Mount Hermon VIDEO

Where the video believes the transfiguration took place.

◆ Factbook: Mount Hermon

Bethsaida VIDEO

One guess for where the crowd came from (Mark 8:22-26). The captions write 'Bethida.'

◆ Factbook: Bethsaida

Jerusalem VIDEO

Where He must go to suffer (16:21).

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

08

Key terms

Passion prediction

BACKGROUND

Jesus foretelling His suffering, death and resurrection (16:21; 17:22-23; 20:18-19).

Sanhedrin

VIDEO

The supreme council of the Jewish people in Jerusalem; the video's summary of 'elders and chief priests and scribes.'

◆ Factbook: Sanhedrin

Stumbling block

VIDEO

Greek skandalon, a trap or obstacle that trips someone. The captions write 'Scandalon.'

Deny himself

VIDEO

To renounce or disown one's own desires, status and self-interest.

Take up his cross

VIDEO

To accept a path of shame and death for Jesus' sake, as a continuing way of life.

Fans and followers

VIDEO

The video's contrast between admirers who seek comfort and disciples who choose the cross.

◆ Factbook: Disciples

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG

for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

δεῖ

dei G1163

It is necessary, must: divine necessity.

Greek · Matt 16:21

πάσχω

paschō G3958

To suffer.

Greek · Matt 16:21

ἐπιτιμάω

epitimaō G2008

To rebuke, warn sternly.

Greek · Matt 16:22

ὑπάγω

hypagō G5217

To go away, depart; 'Go!' or 'Get behind!'

Greek · Matt 16:23; 4:10

◆ Factbook: Satan

σκάνδαλον

skandalon G4625

Stumbling block, trap. Look up: BDAG, σκάνδαλον.

Greek · Matt 16:23

◆ Factbook: Satan

φρονέω

phroneō G5426

To think, set one's mind on.

Greek · Matt 16:23

ἀπαρνέομαι

aparneomai G533

To deny, disown utterly; the word used of Peter's denial (26:34).

Greek · Matt 16:24

σταυρός

stauros G4716

Cross.

Greek · Matt 16:24; Luke 9:23

ψυχή

psychē G5590

Life, soul, self. The same word is 'life' in 16:25 and 'soul' in 16:26.

Greek · Matt 16:25, 26

ἀποδίδωμι

apodidōmi G591

To give back, repay.

Greek · Matt 16:27

שָׁלַם

shalam H7999

To repay, make good; related to shalom. Look up: BDB or HALOT, שלם.

Hebrew · Ps 62:12

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED

Facts most interpreters agree on

Crucifixion in Roman Judea

Rome crucified rebels, slaves and bandits along roads as a public warning. The condemned often carried the crossbeam to the place of execution. 'Take up his cross' would have sounded shocking and shameful, not merely sentimental.

The Sanhedrin

The council in Jerusalem was led by the high priest and included chief priests, elders and scribes. Under Rome it handled religious and many civil matters; it is the body that tries Jesus (26:59).

Psalm 62

A psalm of David about waiting silently for God alone, 'my rock and my salvation' (Psalm 62:2). It warns that men of low and high degree are only a breath, and that riches deserve no trust.

SOURCED

Early witnesses

> *For indeed it was a desire of the adversary that Christ should not suffer.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 54, on 16:23. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *Therefore He said not, Let him renounce himself unto death, but, Let him take up his cross; setting forth the reproachful death; and that not once, nor twice, but throughout all life one ought so to do.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 55, on 16:24. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Having alarmed them therefore hereby, He comforts them also by His good things.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 55, on 16:27. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Who will 'not taste death'?

16:28 has been read of the transfiguration that follows (Chrysostom), of the resurrection and Pentecost, or of the judgment on Jerusalem in AD 70.

Where was this said?

Caesarea Philippi is the last place named, so many place this scene nearby. Matthew does not say, and Mark adds a crowd (Mark 8:34).

Repay: threat or comfort?

The video stresses comfort for those who lose their lives for Christ. Many readers also hear a warning of judgment; both sit in 16:25-27.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video lists 'elders and scribes and Pharisees' in 16:21. The verse names 'the elders and chief priests and scribes'; Pharisees are not mentioned.
- Peter's rebuke is in verse 22, not verse 23 as said once; verse 23 is Jesus' answer.
- 'Matthew 16:4' and '16:4-28' are slips for 16:24 and 16:24-28.
- On tenses: in 16:24 'take up' is an aorist imperative and 'follow' a present imperative. The continuing sense is clearest in Luke's 'daily' (Luke 9:23).
- 'The first time' is best taken as the first plain statement; Jesus had hinted at His death before (9:15; 12:40).
- That the transfiguration happened on Mount Hermon is the video's view; Mount Tabor is the older tradition, and the Gospels do not name the mountain.
- The captions write 'Bethida' for Bethsaida, 'decapus' for Decapolis, and 'Scandalon' for skandalon.

11 · BACKGROUND

From David to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 16:21-28 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1000 BC DEBATED

David: 'You repay a man according to his work'

Psalms 62:12 *Remez: 16:27*

C. 950 BC DEBATED

Proverbs: He will render to man according to his work

Proverbs 24:12

C. AD 27 DEBATED

Jesus to Satan: 'Go, Satan!'

Matthew 4:10

C. AD 29 DEBATED

First plain prediction of His death; 'Get behind Me, Satan!'

Matthew 16:21-23 *This episode*

C. AD 29 DEBATED

The call to deny self and take up the cross

Matthew 16:24-28 *This episode*

C. AD 30 DEBATED

Jesus carries His cross to Golgotha

John 19:17

C. AD 390

Chrysostom: 'throughout all life'

Matthew 16:24

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 8:31-9:1
Mark's parallel
ADDED

Luke 9:22-27
Luke's parallel, 'daily'
ADDED

Matthew 10:38-39
The cross said before
ADDED

John 12:24-26
Unless a grain of wheat dies
ADDED

Philippians 3:7-10
Counting all as loss
ADDED

1 Peter 2:21-24
Peter on following His steps
ADDED

Psalms 62:1-12
The whole psalm behind 16:27
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. ☐ Why do you think Peter heard 'killed' but not 'raised up on the third day'?

2. ☐ Peter meant well. Where might your good intentions be setting your mind on man's interests, not God's?

3. ☐ What does 'take up your cross' look like for you this week, not just once but daily?

4 ☐ Which treasure are you tempted to gain at the cost of your soul?

5 ☐ Do you hear 'He will repay' as a threat or a comfort? Why?

6 ☐ Be honest: in what ways are you more fan than follower?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson, stated plainly: fans of Jesus seek comfort over a cross; followers of Jesus seek the cross over comfort. Fans of Jesus refuse to deny self; denying the self is a deal breaker for them. Followers desire to be like their rabbi, their Lord and Savior, and are fully committed to the adventure of walking after Him, with denying the self as its fundamental part. Fans hear Him preach and say amen, wave their hands, marvel at His miracles, and may even study Him; followers do all that, but they also sacrifice and suffer, because Jesus' destiny is their destiny. The crowds eventually disappeared, because fans follow self. To those who choose the cross over comfort, Jesus promises to repay them.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

pray Psalm 62:5-8 slowly, then write down one comfort you are holding onto more tightly than Jesus. Name one small, concrete way to 'deny yourself' in that area this week.

> *"Jesus' destiny is their destiny.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Wilderness ◆ Temptation of Jesus ◆ Pharisees ◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee ◆ Pentecost ◆ Satan ◆ Angel ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Decapolis ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Bethsaida ◆ Disciples ◆ Healing ◆ Judea ◆ Mammon ◆ Mount Hermon

◆ Prayer ◆ Book of Proverbs ◆ Sanhedrin ◆ Scribe ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

◆ Bridegroom ◆ Philip the tetrarch (Herod Philip II) ◆ Priest ◆ Son of Man ◆ Rabbi ◆ Hades

◆ Jonah (prophet) ◆ Jesus feeds the 5,000 ◆ Wheat ◆ Caesarea Philippi ◆ Church

◆ Jesus feeds the 4,000 ◆ Mount Tabor ◆ The Transfiguration

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Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-32/